

Tutorial Website Brainstorm

Video + PDF learning platform — free & paid plan concept

1. Concept Overview

A website where learners watch step-by-step video tutorials and download companion PDF guides (cheat sheets, worksheets, checklists) for a specific topic. Content is split into a Free plan (to attract and demonstrate value) and a Paid plan (full access, subscription or one-time purchase).

Before building, pick the topic/niche — the structure below works for any subject (tech skills, business, crafts, language, fitness, etc.). Fill in the bracketed placeholders once the niche is decided.

2. Target Audience

- Who are they? (e.g. beginners wanting a practical skill, students, professionals upskilling)
- What problem does the tutorial solve for them?
- Where do they currently learn this — YouTube, other paid courses, in-person classes?
- What would make them pay instead of using free YouTube content? (structure, PDFs, progress tracking, support, certificate)

3. Content Format

Video Tutorials

- Short lessons (5–15 min) grouped into modules/courses
- Hosted on Vimeo/YouTube (unlisted) or a video platform (Bunny.net, Mux, Cloudflare Stream) — avoid self-hosting large video files
- Include captions/subtitles for accessibility

PDF Materials

- Companion guide per lesson (summary, steps, screenshots)
- Worksheets / templates / checklists learners can print or fill in
- A combined "full course workbook" PDF as a paid bonus

4. Site Structure (Pages)

- Home — value proposition, preview video, plan comparison, testimonials
- Course catalog / library — browse by category
- Course/lesson page — video player, PDF download button, progress marker, comments
- Pricing page — Free vs Paid comparison (see table below)
- Account / dashboard — enrolled courses, downloads, progress, certificates
- Blog / resources (optional) — SEO traffic driver, free tips
- Login / Sign up, Checkout, Contact / Support

5. Free Plan vs Paid Plan

Feature	Free Plan	Paid Plan
---------	-----------	-----------

Video tutorials	Limited selection (intro / sample lessons)	Full library, all courses
PDF guides / worksheets	1–2 sample PDFs	Full set, downloadable + printable
Video quality / length	Standard, may include ads or watermark	HD, ad-free, full-length
Progress tracking	Basic (course completion only)	Detailed (per-lesson, quizzes, streaks)
Certificates	Not included	Certificate of completion
Community / support	Public forum access (read-only or limited posts)	Full community + Q&A / comments on lessons
Downloads for offline use	No	Yes
New content	Delayed access (e.g. released after 30 days)	Early / immediate access
Price	\$0	Monthly or annual subscription, or one-time per course

6. Monetization Models to Consider

- **Monthly/annual subscription** — simplest for ongoing new content
- **One-time purchase per course** — good if content is finite (e.g. a single skill)
- **Freemium + upsell** — free intro course, paid for advanced modules
- **Tiered plans** — e.g. Free / Basic / Pro, with Pro adding 1-on-1 support or downloadable source files
- **Bundles** — group several courses/PDFs at a discount

7. Core Features / Functionality

- User accounts with login (email/password, Google login)
- Payment processing (Stripe / PayPal) with subscription billing
- Video hosting with access control (free vs paid videos)
- PDF file storage with gated downloads for paid users
- Progress tracking / completion checkmarks
- Search and filter by topic/level
- Email notifications (new lesson, renewal reminder)
- Optional: certificates, quizzes, community/discussion forum

8. Build Options

Option A — No-code / low-code course platforms

- Teachable, Thinkific, Kajabi, Podia — fastest to launch, built-in payments, hosting, and free/paid gating; less design flexibility, monthly platform fee

Option B — WordPress + LMS plugin

- WordPress + LearnDash / Sensei + WooCommerce or Stripe — more customizable, still moderate setup effort, one-time + hosting costs

Option C — Custom-built website

- Full control over design and features; higher dev cost/time; suitable if this becomes a long-term product with unique needs

9. Suggested Next Steps

- 1. Pick the niche/topic and validate demand (are people searching for this? competitor check)
- 2. Outline the first course — modules, lesson list, matching PDFs
- 3. Decide plan structure and pricing (start simple: Free + one Paid tier)
- 4. Choose a build option (start with no-code platform to test the idea cheaply)
- 5. Record a small pilot course, launch, and gather feedback before scaling